

MacYTDL Release Notes – Version 1.31

New features and improvements

- There is a new setting “Get cookies”. This setting sends the “--cookies-from-browser” option to *yt-dlp* which will load cookies from the selected web browser to be used in downloads. The name of the desired web browser must be chosen from the drop down menu.

Note: Using cookies when downloading enables *yt-dlp* to apply credentials saved in cookies to the download. This can cause issues. For more detail see: <https://github.com/yt-dlp/yt-dlp/wiki/Extractors#exporting-youtube-cookies>.

- There is now a soft limit on the number of playlist items which can be changed by the user. This was previously hard coded in MacYTDL. The limit defaults to 20 and can be changed in the “Admin” dialog. A warning is issued if the proposed playlist has more items than in the set limit. The user may nonetheless continue to download the entire playlist.

- The “File format” drop down can now be used to choose between audio formats: aac, m4a, mp3 and wav.

Note: Choosing a file format will result in an error if that format is not offered by the web site and a warning if the best video available is in a different format. Also, this setting does not replace the “Audio only” feature.

- There is now a runtime setting for video passwords in the Main dialog. This helps with downloading private and similar videos which have a video specific password.
- A new setting “Custom location” is now available for the “.netrc” file. This can be used to point *yt-dlp* to any text file that contains credentials to be used for downloading. The content of that file, however, must be in the “.netrc” format.
- A new setting “Set merge format” has been added to the Settings dialog. This setting tells *yt-dlp* to merge separate download components into a container of the selected type. It overrides the default that is usually set by the serving web site. In many cases this obviates the need for a remux.
- The download “Monitor” can hang if for some reason it has not closed after a long time. In testing, this has happened during recoding of the downloaded video which has taken more than 30 minutes. It seems more likely to hang if the Mac goes into Sleep mode. To try to prevent such hangs, a timer has been added to the Monitor so that it stops if it is still running after 25 minutes. The downloading and any required conversion, however, continue until complete.
- Private videos in playlists are now automatically skipped during parallel downloads. Nonetheless, a warning is still issued before download commences.
- The download Monitor dialog for playlists downloaded in parallel now has the name of the playlist.
- Text entered in a number of places in the “Settings” and “Admin” dialogs is now retained when the related setting is switched off.
- Downloads of playlists now commence much more quickly. This will be especially apparent for playlists with many items. Download speed, however, is unchanged.
- URLs pasted into the MacYTDL text box which are surround by quotes or smart quotes will no longer have to be corrected by the user.
- The DMG image file in which MacYTDL is distributed is now code signed and notarised.

Bug fixes

- Corrections made following a mistake when completing the “Admin” and “Settings” dialogs are now saved.
- It is no longer possible to run MacYTDL from within the disk image file (DMG). MacYTDL is best run from the “Applications” folder (which can be seen by all users).
- Choosing episodes to download from ABC iView in Australia now works correctly when invoked from the MacYTDL Service. The “:” separator now works whereas previously it was removed from the command sent to *yt-dlp* and so the wrong episodes were downloaded.
- For users on of macOS prior to version 10.15, the option to update *yt-dlp* is only available if they have not updated to *yt-dlp* version 2025.08.11.

Note: *yt-dlp* has been significantly improved since August 2025. That 2025.08.11 version will become increasingly unable to function as web sites change.

- The dialog presented during auto-checking *yt-dlp* on startup has been redrafted for users of the nightly version as there is no check that the nightly version is more up-to-date than the version installed.
- The facility to update *yt-dlp* now installs the stable version if user has selected stable in the Utilities dialog. Previously, the nightly version was wrongly installed.
- MacYTDL will now issue a warning for playlists containing more than set in the soft limit (see above) if downloads are to be in parallel.
- *yt-dlp* no longer throws an error during the simulate stage if the Credentials for download dialog is skipped.
- Entries are now deleted from the batch file when “Clear completed URLs from batch file” is on, downloads are in parallel and there were no errors during the download.
- Video details added to batch will not be corrupted by warnings found during the simulation checks.
- A small change has been made to text in the “About MacYTDL” box.

New Known Issues

- It can take a long time for *yt-dlp* to be installed and also when switching from the nightly version to stable version.. The cause is not known.

Workaround: Please, be patient. Research is continuing on why this is happening.

- The SBS Chooser is still not working. Much more work has been done but SBS recently changed their web page structure yet again breaking the current method for parsing the page source.

Workaround: Please, be patient. This should be fixed in a future version of MacYTDL. In the meantime, only download individual episodes from SBS OnDemand.

- MacYTDL might crash with the error: “The variable `branch_execution` is not defined.” I have worked hard on finding these errors and they have not occurred in testing. Nonetheless, they might occur for some users.

Workaround: Reopen MacYTDL and continue with the desired function. Send an email about the error to: macytdl@gmail.com.

- The “QT compatible” and “recode video” features operate even when the downloaded video is already in the desired format.

Workaround: There isn't one. Just wait for the conversion process to finish.

- Sometimes, alerts are not shown when updating/installing components and at other times.

Workaround: There isn't one. This might be fixed in a future version of MacYTDL which will include a more recent version of the *Alerter* tool. However, that will exclude users on old versions of macOS.